Sikh faith. Whereas Bhindranwale willingly and knowingly colluded with the Congress to further its interests, which created a chain of events that led to the destruction of the Akal Takht and the loss of thousands of innocent lives. I hope after reading my book, the management of gurdwaras such as the Southall one would think twice before eulogizinge Bhindranwale, for whatever services to the Sikh faith they believe he might have rendered.

Truth and reconciliation

A lasting solution to the activities of anti-India forces abroad lies in addressing the basic problem at home. It is clear by now that no useful purpose will be served by beating a dead horse, namely the appointments of commissions and committees or even SITs. Even if some more goons or criminals are convicted, that would not address the grave hurt the Sikh community at large has suffered, and the trauma of a bloody decade and half since the launch of Op-2 in 1980. Let justice S.N. Dhingra's SIT be the last in that series.

So how can closure be achieved? In the absence of proper enforcement of criminal procedure, at least grant the Sikhs an opportunity to understand why, how and what actually happened between 1980 and 1995 in Punjab and elsewhere in India, and who the people responsible for it were. Also, they must know how many Sikhs lost their lives, honour and property, and how many are still missing and yet to be accounted for. These issues can only be addressed by means of a very bold political decision by a leader who can carry a majority of Indians with him, to undo a historic wrong done to a particular community of India for no fault of theirs.

Let the nation not live with that guilt forever, as it cannot be brushed under the carpet as Sam Pitroda tried to with his '*hua to hua'* comment. The community and the country need closure, and the sooner the better. I am quite hopeful that if the general public is made aware of the background and origin of these problems, they would be receptive towards, if not appreciative of, such a decision. I have shared the truth as known to me through this book, and I am sure that a number of people in the know of relevant and crucial facts would not hesitate in coming forward with information they